

# Market access becomes policy-contingent

Structural | Evidence current to 2026-09-02 | High on structural policy involvement; medium on the pace and configuration of fragmentation

## 1. The CEO Verdict

Market access is becoming an operating variable shaped by policy, not a fixed characteristic of a country. <sup>[1][2][3][8]</sup>

CEOs need policy-linked scenarios and economically credible options rather than one geopolitical forecast.

## 2. Why Now

2022-23

**Policy returns to strategy**

Investment screening, industrial policy and resilience move into core planning. <sup>[1]</sup>

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2024-25

**Trade routes rewire**

Fragmentation changes sourcing and market access without ending global trade. <sup>[5][6]</sup>

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2026

**Patchwork rules harden**

Tariffs and bloc-like nodes make permission to play more explicit. <sup>[7][3]</sup>

**Figure 1. The evidence path to the present inflection**

The sequence summarizes the archive and does not imply uniform adoption across markets or companies.

### 3. Value at Stake

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>REPORTED ACTUAL</div> <div>31 vs 13</div> <div>OECD economies screening inbound investment in 2023 versus 2010, as cited in the Brief archive. <sup>[1]</sup></div>                                                     | <div>SURVEY</div> <div>90% / 25%</div> <div>share of surveyed manufacturers for which a 25% tariff would make offshoring uncompetitive in the cited Factory of the Future study. <sup>[2]</sup></div> |
| <div>MODELLED ESTIMATE</div> <div>4 nodes</div> <div>geographical nodes used in the cited 2026 BCG framework for a more patchwork world order; this is an analytical model, not an official bloc count. <sup>[3]</sup></div> | <div>FORECAST</div> <div>1 pp</div> <div>potential drag on trade growth in the most exposed regions from sustained high energy prices, as cited in the Brief. <sup>[4]</sup></div>                    |

Each anchor was checked against the cited passage; the measurement type is shown above the value.

The relevant economics combine tariff and compliance cost, localization capex, time to qualify, foregone scale and the option value of alternative routes. A policy-protected footprint is not resilient if it remains structurally unproductive. <sup>[3][1][2][9][8]</sup>

### 4. How the Game Changes

|    |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <div>Policy changes addressability</div> <div>Rules determine which customers, assets and inputs are economically reachable. <sup>[3][8]</sup></div>                      |
| 02 | <div>Protection changes footprint economics</div> <div>Tariffs can reverse offshoring math while leaving structural productivity unchanged. <sup>[2]</sup></div>          |
| 03 | <div>Hidden dependencies defeat nominal diversification</div> <div>Different suppliers can share one ownership, processing or control chokepoint. <sup>[1][9]</sup></div> |

**Figure 2. The mechanisms reshaping advantage and economics**  
Source: Weekly Brief Atlas analysis of the cited Briefs and authoritative research.

## 5. Your Exposure & Strategic Choices

Where exposure concentrates

|            |                                                                                 |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Government | Policy credibility depends on predictable rules and deployable alternatives.    |
| Business   | Treat permission to play and dependency control as commercial design variables. |
| Investors  | Separate policy rents from sustainable operating advantage.                     |

Figure 3. Where the trend enters the enterprise system

Choices that cannot be delegated

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>CEO CHOICE · ATLAS JUDGMENT</b></p> <p><b>Localize or preserve options</b></p> <p>Which flows justify local capacity, and which should remain switchable across markets?</p> <p>Trade-off: Localization secures access but can lock in high cost; options preserve flexibility but require qualification and carrying cost.</p> | <p><b>CEO CHOICE · ATLAS JUDGMENT</b></p> <p><b>Shape policy or adapt silently</b></p> <p>Where can evidence-based engagement improve rules, and where must the company redesign around them?</p> <p>Trade-off: Engagement can improve implementation; overreliance on influence delays necessary operating choices.</p> |
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These are decision frames developed by Weekly Brief Atlas, not claims attributed to the cited sources.

## 6. CEO Agenda & Signposts

### Action sequence

|                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>01 NEXT 90 DAYS</b><br><b>Map policy exposure</b><br>Link earnings and critical flows to concrete policy instruments. | <b>02 NEXT 90 DAYS</b><br><b>Define triggers</b><br>Set actions for tariff, sanctions and access scenarios. |
| <b>03 6-12 MONTHS</b><br><b>Qualify options</b><br>Secure non-correlated suppliers, routes and market structures.        |                                                                                                             |

Figure 4. The management response in sequence

### Leading indicators

|           |                                      |
|-----------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>01</b> | Revenue exposed to policy permission |
| <b>02</b> | Time to qualify alternatives         |
| <b>03</b> | Tariff-dependent margin              |
| <b>04</b> | Common upstream dependency share     |

### What would change our view

- Trade may continue growing despite fragmentation.
- Policy reversals can strand localization investments.
- Diversification can add cost without reducing common-node risk.

### Evidence boundary

High on structural policy involvement; medium on the pace and configuration of fragmentation  
The cited Briefs provide directional and survey evidence; they do not predict the duration or final form of any specific tariff or sanctions regime.

## Notes and Sources

Superscript numbers refer to this list; page references use printed report pagination where available. Strategic choices and decision frames are Atlas interpretations.

[1] Weekly Brief · 2024-06-24 · How to Face Rising Geopolitical Risk

[2] Weekly Brief · 2026-06-09 · The New Economics of Manufacturing

[3] Weekly Brief · 2026-01-13 · Getting Ready for a Patchwork World Order

[4] Weekly Brief · 2026-03-30 · A New Energy Reality—Higher Prices, Longer Disruption, Harder Choices

[5] Weekly Brief · 2024-01-08 · Navigating the Dramatic Shifts in Global Trade

[6] Authoritative research · WTO · 2025-12-15 · Global Value Chain Development Report 2025: Rewiring GVCs in a Changing Global Economy

[7] Weekly Brief · 2026-03-03 · US Tariffs—Uncertainty Reigns, but with More Constraints

[8] Authoritative research · WTO · 2026-03-19 · Global Trade Outlook and Statistics — March 2026

[9] Authoritative research · U.S.-China Economic and Security Review Commission · 2025-11-18 · 2025 Annual Report to Congress